

The IPL's Disparate Decision Makers

The IPL's Governing Council is made up of BCCI officials, politicians doubling as BCCI officials and a select trio of cricketers

LALIT MODI

Chairman and Commissioner, IPL

SHASHANK MANOHAR President, BCCI

N. SRINIVASAN Secretary, BCCI

NIRANJAN SHAH IPL Vice-Chairman

INDERJIT SINGH BINDRA

President, Punjab Cricket Association

M.P. PANDOVE Honorary Treasurer, BCCI

CHIRAYU AMIN BCCI Vice-President

ARUN JAITLEY

BCCI Vice-President, and President, DDCA

SANJAY JAGDALE BCCI Joint Secretary

RAJEEV SHUKLA

Chairman, Media and Finance Committee, BCCI

FAROOQ ABDULLAH

President, J&K Cricket Association

RAVI SHASTRI

Former India Captain

SUNIL GAVASKAR

Former India Captain

MANSOOR ALI KHAN PATAUDI

Former India Captain

■ Politicians ■ Cricketers

26% of KINGS XI PUNJAB is owned by Ness Wadia, 25% by Preity Zinta, and 24.5% each by Mohit Burman and Karan Paul.

44.1% of RAJASTHAN ROYALS is owned by Suresh Chellaram. Raj Kundra bought an 11.7% stake last year. Manoj Badale's stake is unclear.

How much Khan, Jai Mehta and Juhi Chawla own in KOLKATA KNIGHT RIDERS is not known.

25% of Team Kochi's free equity is shared by Rendezvous Sports World between Kisan, Shailendra and Pushpa Gaikwad, Sunanda Pushkar, Pooja Gulati, Jayant Kotalwar, Vishnu Prasad, and Sundip Agarwal. Rendezvous Sports holds 1%, Anchor 27%, Parinee Developers 26%, Film Waves Combine 12%, Anand Shyam 8% and Vivek Venugopal 1%.



The BCCI can restore its credibility by debarring those with commercial interests in the Board's ventures from holding office in the BCCI or the IPL.

had lost out in the bid. Modi's men were happy to pass, onto print and TV, the information they say was given by Tharoor's most voluble associate. That Team Kochi was kosher because thanks to Shailendra Gaikwad's social circle, it had even roped in two of India's cricketing gods.

In this tit for tat war, every team may just be forced to declare its ownership structure. Like, does Ness Wadia own 26 per cent, Preity Zinta 25 per cent, Mohit and Karan Paul 24.5 per cent of King's XI Punjab? If Raj Kundra owns 11.7 per cent of Rajasthan Royals, what about Lachlan Murdoch, Manoj Badale and Chellaram? Where are their companies based? How is Kolkata Knight Riders divided between Shah Rukh Khan, Jai Mehta and Juhi Chawla?

Like Pataudi said, even the IPL Governing Council did not know and it is Kochi that has made it an issue. Until now the governing council chose to turn a blind eye to the deeds of the IPL, which is euphemistically described as a "domestic tournament" and a "BCCI subcommittee". The 14-member council is made up of eight BCCI officials; the rest of the six are evenly split between politicians and three ex-cricketers. When asked, four of these members did not specify what a council quorum amounted to. All meetings though they said, were "well attended".

Politicians of all spectrums ranging from NCP leader Sharad Pawar to Leader of Opposition (Rajya Sabha) Arun Jaitley, Union Minister Farooq Abdullah and Congress MP Rajeev Shukla are involved in cricket admin-

istration. Except Pawar, a former BCCI president, all three men belong to the IPL Governing Council. Every politician is drawn to cricket because of its two most seductive components: the opportunity to perpetually be in the public eye without any electoral prerequisites and regular involvement in business deals with exponentially growing numbers of all kinds.

Along with the IPL council meeting next week, the BCCI could also hold an emergency meeting and pass a blanket rule to wash away all conflict of interest issues and IPL Kochi dramas. The way to start: debar anyone with commercial interest in the IPL or BCCI's other commercial ventures from holding any office in the BCCI, its state units and the IPL.

After accusing Modi of offering the Kochi franchise \$50 million to exit the stage, Rendezvous representative Satyajit Gaikwad smoothly explained on TV why working with Modi would not be an issue, "He has conducted the IPL very well. Every Indian is proud of it." Particularly the sights and sounds of Modi and Tharoor trying to nuke each other out of the sport's deepest gold mine. The BCCI could now shift the powers of the IPL chairman to someone else inducted under a new designation. An IPL executive says, "The issue is not the League, the issue is the man and Modi is fighting for his own survival. If Modi loses his job or his power, it's no consolation to him that Tharoor may have lost his job too." Or the BCCI could do what it always does. Act just like an industry insider's description of its most accurate full name: 'The Board of Compromise in Cricket in India'. **with Kaveree Bamzai**